

~~SECRET~~ (FSD4)

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ACTION EUR-00

INFO	LOG-00	CDPY-01	AOS-00	INR-10	SS-00	CIAE-00	000E-00
	H-01	IO-19	NSCE-00	NSAE-00	SSD-00	L-03	PA-02
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FM AMEMBASSY HELSINKI
TO SECSTATE WASHDC IMMEDIATE 9955
INFO AMEMBASSY MOSCOW IMMEDIATE
USMISSION GENEVA PRIORITY
USMISSION NATO PRIORITY
USCINCEUR VATHINGEN GE PRIORITY

UNCLAS HELSINKI 05058

E.O. 12356: N/A
TAGS: PARM, PREL, US, UR, FI
SUBJECT: VLADIMIR SEMYONOV MAKES QUICK TRIP TO FINLAND
TO BRIEF PRESIDENT ON REYKJAVIK SUMMIT

1. SUMMARY: SOVIET AMBASSADOR VLADIMIR SEMYONOV BRIEFED PRESIDENT KOIVISTO OCTOBER 15 ON SOVIET VIEWS RE REYKJAVIK SUMMIT AND LATER MET THE PRESS. IN HIS PUBLIC REMARKS, SEMYONOV EMPHASIZED THAT THE SOVIET "PACKAGE" HAD TO BE TAKEN AS A WHOLE, AND THAT NO PARTIAL SOLUTIONS, SUCH AS ON INF, WERE BEING CONSIDERED. HE AVOIDED DIRECT ATTACKS ON PRESIDENT REAGAN, BUT STUCK TO THE GORBACHEV WORDING THAT THE PRESIDENT "IS UNDER THE INFLUENCE OF THE "MILITARY-INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX". DESPITE CRITICISM OF THE U.S. POSITION ON INF, SEMYONOV WAS UPBEAT, NOTING THAT CONSIDERABLE PROGRESS HAD BEEN MADE. END SUMMARY.

2. SEMYONOV, WHO LED THE SOVIET DELEGATION TO THE SALT I
NEGOTIATIONS HELD IN HELSINKI AND VIENNA 1969-72, BRIEFED
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PRESIDENT KOIVISTO ON THE SOVIET VIEW OF THE REYKJAVIK SUMMIT. "BOTH SIDES," ACCORDING TO THE SWEDISH-LANGUAGE "HUFVUSTADENBLADET", UNDERScoreD THE IMPORTANCE OF "CONTINUING THE SUPERPOWER NEGOTIATIONS."

3. THE GENERAL TONE WAS THAT GREAT PROGRESS HAD BEEN MADE, DESPITE THE LACK OF FINAL AGREEMENT. NOTING THE CPSU POLITBUD'S APPROVAL OF GORBACHEV'S EFFORTS, SEMYONOV SAID THAT A "VIGOROUS EFFORT" SHOULD NOW BE

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MADE FOR A "TOTAL LIQUIDATION" OF NUCLEAR WEAPONS.

4. "PACKAGE DEAL" WAS THE DAY'S WATCHWORD: THE NEGOTIATIONS WHICH WILL OCCUR MUST "TAKE PLACE WITHIN THE PACKAGE AND CONCERN THE WHOLE PACKAGE." ASKED IF A SEPARATE INF DEAL WERE POSSIBLE, SEMYONOV SAID IT WAS NOT, AND EXPLAINED THAT EARLIER SOVIET APPROVAL FOR A SEPARATE SOLUTION WAS CONNECTED WITH "ANOTHER NEGOTIATION SITUATION". HE EXPLAINED THE SOVIET POSITION ON THE ABM TREATY AS THAT "IF ONE CUTS DOWN STRATEGIC AND INTER-MEDIATE RANGE WEAPONS, ONE SHOULD BE SURE THAT NO NEW WEAPONS TYPES ARE BEING DEVELOPED IN THE MEANTIME." BOTH "UUSI SUOMI" AND INDEPENDENT "HELSINGIN SANOMAT" NOTED THAT SEMYONOV'S LINE ON A PACKAGE DEAL CONTRADICTED THE STATEMENTS MADE BY VIKTOR KARPOV TO THE EFFECT THAT INF WOULD BE HANDLED SEPARATELY.

5. SEMYONOV CONFIRMED THAT ALL QUESTIONS EXCEPT SOI HAD BEEN SOLVED IN A "SATISFACTORY MANNER" FOR THE USSR. EXPANDING ON SOVIET CONCERNS OVER SOI, HE ALLEGED THAT THE PROGRAM WOULD (A) CREATE NEW WEAPONS OF MASS DESTRUCTION WHICH WOULD DESTROY THE SUPERPOWER EQUILIBRIUM, AND, (B) FORCE THE USSR INTO A NEW ARMS RACE AND "SLOW UP" THE PARTY'S MARCH ECONOMIC PROGRAM.

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HE CLAIMED THE USSR WOULD ANSWER SOI WITH AN "ASYMMETRIC PROGRAM", BUT DID NOT ELABORATE.

6. WITH REGARD TO THE U.S., SEMYONOV SAID HE EXPECTED THAT SOVIET PROPOSALS WOULD BE "RECONSIDERED". HE ADDED THAT THE U.S. COULD MAKE NEW PROPOSALS IN GENEVA, BUT HOPED THAT THEY WOULD NOT TRY TO DISMANTLE THE AGREEMENTS ALREADY REACHED IN ICELAND. HE SAID THAT THE REAGAN ADMINISTRATION IS UNDER THE INFLUENCE OF THE "MILITARY-INDUSTRIAL COMPLEX" BUT EXPLAINED THAT THE "DEGREE OF INFLUENCE VARIES". HE EXPRESSED HOPE THAT AN AGREEMENT COULD BE REACHED WITH THE CURRENT ADMINISTRATION, AND SAID GORBACHEV COULD MEET THE PRESIDENT AGAIN IF THERE WERE "GUARANTEES FOR RESULTS".

7. SUMMING UP THE SUMMIT, SEMYONOV CALLED IT "ESPECIALLY SIGNIFICANT," SAID IT WAS "AN IMPORTANT STAGE" IN THE DEVELOPMENT OF U.S.-SOVIET RELATIONS, AND "A QUESTION OF A SIGNIFICANT STEP FORWARD IN COMPLETELY DECISIVE QUESTIONS" AND THAT A "BREAKTHROUGH" WOULD HAVE TAKEN PLACE "IF REAGAN HAD NOT SAID STOP".

8. COMMENT: WHILE SEMYONOV GOT IN THE EXPECTED JIBES AT THE U.S., WE FOUND THE GENERAL TONE OF HIS REMARKS TO BE REMARKABLY POSITIVE. EMBASSY HAS ALSO RECEIVED SOME INFORMAL PRESS INQUIRIES AS TO WHETHER A SIMILAR

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U.S. "BRIEFER" WOULD BE COMING TO HELSINKI. SCHNABEL

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